founded it to provide infrastructure for people from his former organization to fight in Afghanistan. Despite being a stand-alone outfit and receiving support from al-Qaeda, Shah Sahib was known on the ground as a Lashkar group.[84] However, according to one Pakistani researcher familiar with the group, it was actually closer to people who officially worked on the JuD-side of the organization.[85]

Fighting in Afghanistan necessitated an increased presence in the Tribal Areas and greater integration with the mélange of jihadi outfits located there, rather than just those few that were directly connected to Lashkar. Its group identity remained that of an India-centric, Ahl-e-Hadith outfit whose leadership and top operatives were close to the ISI. Yet its members were now operating amidst Pashtun tribesmen and Deobandi militants, some of whom were at war with the state. During conversations with high-ranking members of JuD and Lashkar militants, they made clear their anger at Pakistan's rulers and admitted that some of their members were motivated to join the insurgency. However, they also criticized the jihad being waged against the country and made clear their ideological disdain for those actors responsible.[86] These tensions existed not only within the organization, but also between Lashkar's leaders and the outfits with which they were collaborating. Lashkar's relationship with the ISI, which sometimes used the group to eliminate militants threatening the state, led some in the TTP, al-Qaeda and among the various Deobandi militants to question the group's loyalty even after it entered the Afghan theater.[87] Thus, different cliques co-existed within Lashkar, which in turn now existed in a space where various outfits with overlapping and competing agendas were present. Being a distinct faction, inside a group or space where multiple factions are present, includes both separateness and togetherness. As a result of Lashkar's expanding presence in FATA, opportunities for collaboration and conflict increased.

Collaboration with other outfits included: working together to recruit and infiltrate fighters into Afghanistan; sharing safe houses and resources including weapons, explosives and information; joint training; and fighting together in Afghanistan.[88]

Joint training took place at the organizational level and some of Lashkar's instructors worked in camps belonging to other outfits, though at times this may have been done in a freelance capacity. Although Lashkar